



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Castle Rock Christian Academy
School Website: <https://crcacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)**

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: Austin Classical School explicitly centers its mission on cultivating “wise, virtuous, and humble” students by pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty under Christ’s lordship; it names and employs the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), requires Latin, teaches Great Books and history (not “social studies”), and describes memory work, recitation, debate/discussion, Socratic method, and rhetoric/thesis defense in the upper grades. It articulates theological study (Christian Studies with exegesis, hermeneutics, apologetics, and ethics) as a core throughline and operates a collaborative model that makes parents co-teachers, with open on-campus engagement and tours. These align closely with the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon of positive indicators (truth/goodness/beauty; theology; Trivium; Great Books; Socratic; memorization/recitation; parent partnership) while avoiding negative indicators (e.g., “21st-century skills,” “college and career readiness,” “project-based learning dominance,” values-neutral language). - Method note: All categories below include mandatory keyword analysis using the Six Essential Elements/lexicon as the scoring scaffold, per your instruction set. Positive/negative indicators cited from the Six Elements lexicon are included for transparency.

Six-Category Audit (with keyword analysis)**1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations**

- Keywords found on site:
- “glorify Jesus Christ,” “classical, Christian education,” “wise, virtuous, and humble” students; “goodness, truth, and beauty”; “image of God”; “Christian Studies,” “Exegesis & Hermeneutics,” “Apologetics & Ethics,” “Development of Christian Doctrine”.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Religious/Metaphysical):
- Transcendental moral realism: repeated “truth, goodness, beauty” and “virtue/wisdom” terms align with the lexicon’s moral realism signals.
- Grounded in Theology: explicit theological course of study (exegesis, hermeneutics, apologetics, ethics) aligns with “theology/faith and reason/Christian formation” indicators.
- Liturgical/communal practices: while explicit chapel/liturgy language is limited, the program includes choir and communal Christian identity (we did not see “daily chapel” explicitly).
- Negative indicator scan:
- No “values-neutral,” “religiously neutral,” or “secular” language present; school is candidly Christian and confessional for faculty/staff.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 10 (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; wisdom; Christ/Christian; image of God; Christian Studies; Exegesis; Hermeneutics; Apologetics; Ethics)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 85% (two of the three subdimensions are strong—moral realism, theology; liturgy/communal worship referenced indirectly through music/choir but not a formal chapel rhythm)
- Score: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- Keywords found on site:
- Aim: “cultivate wisdom and virtue ... through the contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” and “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation ... [more about] an eternal purpose”.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Purpose/Goal):
- “wisdom,” “virtue,” “truth, goodness, beauty,” “formation” and “eternal purpose” directly match lexicon positives and explicitly reject utilitarian “job training” aims as primary.
- Negative indicator scan:
- None of “college-and-career readiness/21st-century skills/workforce prep” framing; the website explicitly contrasts such aims with its purpose.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 9 (wisdom, virtue, formation language; truth/goodness/beauty; great conversation; human flourishing; love of learning; eternal/telos language)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 100% (all three purpose subdimensions salient)
- Score: CLASSICAL

3) Curriculum

- Keywords found on site:
- Trivium (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), with stage descriptions; memory/recitation/songs; Latin required; formal logic; rhetoric; Great Books/Western tradition; history by name (not “social studies”); integrated curriculum linking disciplines; rhetoric-stage thesis defense.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Curriculum):
- Seven Liberal Arts/Trivium and classical languages are explicit; Great Books/primary texts and “great conversation” appear; “integration/harmony of subjects” is emphasized across schedule and FAQs.
- Negative indicator scan:
- No dominance of “project-based/experiential learning,” “STEM-first,” or “social studies” terminology detected; courses named “History” and classical literature are foregrounded.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 12 (Trivium; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Latin; Logic; Rhetoric; Great Books; History; Integration; Memory; Recitation; Choir/Music; Thesis)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 90% (Quadrivium is present implicitly via math/science/music but not labeled as Quadrivium)
- Score: CLASSICAL

4) Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- Keywords found on site:
- Grammar stage uses “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic stage employs “debate and discussion”; Rhetoric stage emphasizes “thesis defense”; “Socratic method” employed; imitation in rhetoric training; explicit stress on discussion, reading, writing, reasoned persuasion.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Pedagogy):
- Memorization/recitation/chant/singing align with the lexicon’s memory-work indicators; Socratic seminar/disputation; rhetoric exercises and oration/thesis match classical pedagogy; imitation as a formative practice appears in rhetoric description.
- Negative indicator scan:
- No “project-based only,” “student-directed constructivism,” or “experiential learning focus” language as a dominant pedagogy; tech policy prefers “embodied learning” and books over devices.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 9 (memorization; recitation; songs; debate/discussion; Socratic; thesis/defense; rhetoric composition; imitation; oratory)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage estimate: 85% (three of four pedagogical pillars explicit; “restful learning/schol  ” not explicitly named)
- Score: CLASSICAL

5) Faculty

- Keywords found on site:
- Teachers described as “Jesus  loving men and women ... helping form the souls of our children,” with “quality lesson plans and inspired classroom teaching”; degreed professionals who joyfully subscribe to Statement of Faith; clear hire standards; teachers keep office hours to support parent co  teachers—indicators of mentorship and service ethos.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Faculty):
- “Teachers as models of virtue”/mentors are strongly implied; collegial, service  oriented partnership with families present; explicit “portrait of a teacher” document not found, but the language of formation and mentorship aligns with the positive lexicon.
- Negative indicator scan:
- No “teacher as mere facilitator” or certification  jargon without formation found.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 5 (formation of souls; virtue/faith commitments; mentoring posture; degreed professionals; availability/office hours)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 70% (two subdimensions strong; formal “portrait” not located)
- Score: CLASSICAL

6) Parents and Community

- Keywords found on site:
- Explicit “co  teacher parent” role; weekly lesson plans and teacher office hours on homeschool days; family partnership language; on  campus tours and preview nights; recommended readings/resources/podcast for prospective/parents—indicators of parent education and open hospitality.
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators (Parents/Community):
- “Partnership with parents/co  educators” is central to the collaborative schedule; parent formation via recommended reading and resources; open invitations to visit campus are routine.
- Negative indicator scan:
- No “parent as customer” or “minimal parent involvement” signals.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 7 (parent partnership; co  teachers; office hours; tours; preview nights; resources/recommended reading; explicit community emphasis)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 90% (strong partnership and openness; explicit “parent book clubs/seminars” not identified)
- Score: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Judgment - Based on the positive keyword density and breadth of coverage in all six elements—and the absence of negative  lexicon signals—the school is rated: CLASSICAL. - Grounds: Clear alignment with the Six Essential Elements’ positive indicators: truth/goodness/beauty; cultivation of wisdom and virtue; theological grounding; Trivium/Latin/Great Books; Socratic/memory/recitation/rhetoric; teacher formation/mentorship; and parent partnership.

Notes on Lexicon Use - This audit used the “Six Essential Elements” keyword lists for positive and negative indicators to evaluate ACS’s website claims and artifacts (e.g., “truth, goodness, beauty,” “virtue/wisdom,” “Trivium,” “Latin,” “Great Books,” “Socratic,” “memorization/recitation,” “parent partnership”), and to flag potential negatives (“values  neutral,” “21st  century skills,” “project  based learning dominance”). No negative hits were detected in ACS’s public materials during this crawl.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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